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We're here in Amsterdam with Chris Jensen, and Chris is the Communications Manager for SAIL 2025 in Amsterdam. A tremendous event. Chris, welcome to the program.

Thank you so much. Now, Chris, it's gone fantastically well this year. This is the first one in 10 years.

Can you give us a bit of a background about SAIL Amsterdam itself? Yeah, it's the largest event in the Netherlands, and it has been there since 1975. And it has taken place every five years, but the last edition was canceled due to COVID. So now we had to wait for 10 years, but we had a triple jubilee with 750 years of Amsterdam.

It was also the 10th edition and 50 years of SAIL, so it was quite a big thing. For those who don't know, it's a big collection of tall ships, ships and boats of all shapes and sizes. That's true, and they come from all over the globe.

So we have ships here from South America, from Asia, from Europe, and they all gather here in Amsterdam Harbor, and they are here together with all the Dutch ships. So we have a decorum of thousands and thousands of ships. It's really incredible.

There was a big news story about a ship that hit the Brooklyn Bridge tragically recently, and that was on its way here. No, they didn't make it. Oh, they didn't make it, no.

But yesterday, we had the crew parade. So all the crews of the international tall ships went in a parade to the city center of Amsterdam. And on the main square of the city, they all made hearts with their hands.

We made a picture, and we sent them to Mexico to give them a warm feeling from Amsterdam. Oh, that's wonderful. And I noticed yesterday, on the Saturday, the people said it was one of the biggest turnouts for SAIL in SAIL's history.

That's true. The crowds on both the water and also on the docks, it has been incredible. It just keeps coming, and it's also nice that you see people from all backgrounds.

So it's like old people, young people. Everyone is gathering here to meet the international crews, and that's what makes SAIL so unique. It's really an international gathering, and it's like a celebration of different cultures.

The thing is, I've been out on the water on the press team, and you graciously host us as press here. The views are fantastic. Yesterday, I saw the ex-queen, Queen Beatrix, and she was on her little boat, which is beautiful.

Tell us about that. We have been in good connection with the royal family since the start in 1975.

The royal family has always visited us.

And also this edition, so on Wednesday, we had the King. And then, since Wednesday, every day, there has been some royal participation in the event, and that makes it, of course, very special for the crowds on the water, for the crowds on the docks, who just see them and wave at them, and that makes it extra special. And the great thing about SAIL is that all those tall ships line up and berth here, and people can actually go on and see the ships firsthand.

Yeah, that's true. It's the biggest event in the Netherlands, but it's also the biggest freely accessible event, so people don't have to buy tickets or anything. And then, indeed, the ships come from Ameure.

This is a city here at the coast side. And then they go in a parade of more than 10 kilometres to Amsterdam, and they are, like, gathering with all the small boats and ships. And then they dock here in the harbour, and then they are freely accessible for five days.

So people are just going on the ships, meet the international crews, meet new cultures, meet new ideas, and that's wonderful. The best thing is that there's so many additional events. You have the SAIL stage, you have the fireworks, all sorts of things.

Sometimes you could think a bit too much. No, no, no, it's not like that. But we have over 200 activities over five days, and it's like for everyone, there's something to find.

For the small kids, we have the SEAL Kids Club, where they just learn how to sail, how to work on the water. And we have concerts for our young people, for elderly people. For everyone, there's something to find.

What are the plans for the future? I know the next edition is, what, 2030? And you're already planning for that, I should imagine. Yeah, of course, because those international tour ships, they have calendars of many years to follow, so we're already in contact with them. And of course, they are now very, very uplifted here by the Amsterdam Spirit, so now we have to make the deals for 2030.

And quite some ships have already confirmed their participation next edition, because this is something they want to experience again. Well, if you did miss SAIL 2025, there's always one in five years, which comes around really fast. And 2030 sounds like it's a long way away, but it isn't really.

What about your background? How did you get involved with SAIL? Well, I was working here for a communications agency in Amsterdam, and I was so lucky that it was my first project 11 years ago to be working on. And now, since then, I've been connected with the event, but for me, it's extra special because I'm actually a son of sailors. So I come from two sailing families, and also my family is now here in the dock with their own boat, and they are also proud, so that makes it

an extra warm feeling.

Chris Jensen, thank you very much, the Communications Director of SAIL 2025. Thank you very much for being on the program. Very shortly, you'll have the new website up for SAIL 230, I should imagine.

Of course, then you have to just visit www.sail.nl. But I would say what is the special proposition of SAIL is that you can make a world trip or a world tour in one day.